

AFTER THE BIRTH

OVER 40 WEEKS, THE FERTILIZED EGG HAS CHANGED FROM FETUS TO NEWBORN BABY. ALL ORGAN SYSTEMS ARE IN PLACE – SOME QUICKLY ADAPT TO LIFE WITHOUT AN UMBILICAL CORD, WHILE OTHERS ONLY DEVELOP FULLY IN ADOLESCENCE.

NEWBORN ANATOMY

Special features in a baby's anatomy help it to grow and develop outside the uterus. Fontanelles allow the skull to expand as the brain grows; they become bone by the time the child is about six years old. Cartilage

in the joints and at the end of long bones allows the skeleton to grow rapidly. In the fetus, the liver produced all the red blood cells, and this task is now taken over by the bone marrow.

